



GRACEPATH NETWORK

Growing in Christ • Walking in Grace • Impacting Lives

STEWARDSHIP

Faithfully Managing What
God Has Entrusted to Us

A BIBLICAL STEWARDSHIP COURSE



TIME
Redeem
Your Time



TALENTS
Develop
Your Gifts



FINANCES
Manage
Wisely



RELATIONSHIPS
Love and Serve
Others



OPPORTUNITIES
Recognize
and Seize



REWARDS
Live for
Eternity

BE FAITHFUL IN LITTLE AND YOU WILL BE ENTRUSTED WITH MUCH.

MATTHEW 25:21

STEWARDSHIP

A Biblical Course on Faithful Management of God's Resources

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COURSE OBJECTIVES

By the end of this course, participants should be able to:

1. Define biblical stewardship and explain its importance in the Christian life.
2. Understand that God is the Owner of all things and believers are His managers.
3. Identify the major areas of stewardship, including time, talents, finances, relationships, and opportunities.
4. Develop practical habits for using time wisely and productively.
5. Discover, develop, and faithfully use spiritual gifts and natural abilities.
6. Apply biblical principles for earning, spending, saving, giving, and managing finances.
7. Build healthy and God-honouring relationships through faithful stewardship.
8. Recognize and maximize God-given opportunities for service and ministry.
9. Understand the rewards associated with faithful stewardship.
10. Commit to lifelong faithfulness in managing everything God has entrusted to them.

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INTRODUCTION

Stewardship is one of the most important principles in the Christian life. It is the recognition that God is the Owner of all things and that believers are entrusted as managers of His resources.

Everything we possess—our time, talents, finances, opportunities, relationships, influence, and spiritual gifts—has been entrusted to us by God for His purposes and glory.

Throughout Scripture, faithful men and women demonstrated stewardship by using what God had given them wisely and obediently. Joseph managed Egypt's resources during famine. Esther used her position to save her people. Paul invested his life in preaching the Gospel and discipline believers.

Stewardship is therefore much more than managing money. It encompasses every area of life and calls believers to faithfully manage God's gifts in ways that honour Him, bless others, and advance His Kingdom.

A faithful steward understands that life is not about ownership but responsibility. The question is not:

"What do I own?"

but rather,

"How am I managing what God has entrusted to me?"

CHAPTER 1

Understanding Biblical Stewardship

Memory Verse

Psalm 24:1

“The earth is the LORD'S, and the fullness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.” (KJV)

Introduction

Stewardship is a foundational biblical principle that teaches believers how to relate to God, possessions, responsibilities, opportunities, and blessings. Before a person can become a faithful steward, they must first understand that God is the rightful Owner of everything.

Nothing we possess truly belongs to us. Everything has been entrusted to us by God for a season and for a purpose. From the beginning of creation, God appointed humanity as caretakers of His creation, giving them responsibility to manage it wisely.

Biblical stewardship extends beyond money. It includes our time, talents, spiritual gifts, relationships, opportunities, influence, possessions, and ministry responsibilities. Every believer will one day stand before God and give an account for how they managed what He entrusted to them.

The central question of stewardship is not:

“What belongs to me?”

but rather,

“How does God want me to use what belongs to Him?”

1. The Meaning of Stewardship

A steward is a person entrusted with the responsibility of managing the property, affairs, or resources of another person.

In biblical times, wealthy landowners often appointed trusted servants to oversee their households, finances, workers, and property. Although the steward had authority to manage these resources, he did not own them. His responsibility was to use them according to the owner's instructions.

Likewise, believers are God's stewards who manage what belongs to Him.

Scripture Reading

1 Corinthians 4:2

“Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.”

God does not primarily require success, wealth, popularity, or influence. He requires **faithfulness**.

Key Truth

Stewardship is the faithful management of God's resources according to God's purposes.

2. God Is the Owner of Everything

The foundation of stewardship begins with recognizing God's ownership.

Psalm 24:1

“The earth is the LORD'S, and the fullness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.”

This verse teaches that:

- God owns the earth.
- God owns every resource.
- God owns every person.
- God owns every blessing.
- God owns our lives.

Many people view themselves as owners of their possessions, careers, talents, and accomplishments. However, Scripture reminds us that everything ultimately belongs to God.

Haggai 2:8

“The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the LORD of hosts.”

Deuteronomy 8:18

“But thou shalt remember the LORD thy God: for it is he that giveth thee power to get wealth.”

Recognizing God's ownership produces humility because we realize that everything we have is a gift from Him.

Reflection

When we acknowledge God as Owner, we stop asking,

“How can I use my resources for myself?”

and begin asking,

“How can I use God's resources for His glory?”

3. Humanity's Role as Managers

While God is the Owner, humanity has been appointed as managers.

Genesis 1:28

“Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion...”

God entrusted mankind with the responsibility of caring for His creation.

This dominion was not permission to exploit creation but a command to manage it wisely and responsibly.

Believers are called to:

- Manage resources wisely.
- Care for creation.
- Use talents productively.
- Serve others faithfully.
- Advance God's Kingdom.

Illustration

A property manager may oversee a large estate, but the property does not belong to him.

Likewise, we may possess houses, businesses, ministries, finances, and influence, but we are only caretakers of what belongs to God.

4. Areas of Stewardship

Stewardship affects every area of life.

A. Stewardship of Time

Time is one of God's most valuable gifts.

Each day God gives us twenty-four hours to serve Him, fulfil our responsibilities, and accomplish His purposes.

Ephesians 5:16

“Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.”

Faithful stewards use time wisely and avoid wasting opportunities.

B. Stewardship of Talents and Gifts

Every believer has received abilities and spiritual gifts.

1 Peter 4:10

“As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another.”

God expects us to develop and use our gifts for the benefit of others and for His glory.

C. Stewardship of Finances

Money is a tool entrusted to us by God.

Luke 16:11

“If therefore ye have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who will commit to your trust the true riches?”

How we earn, spend, save, give, and manage money reveals our spiritual priorities.

D. Stewardship of Relationships

God entrusts people into our lives.

We are responsible for treating others with love, respect, kindness, and integrity.

E. Stewardship of Ministry Opportunities

Every opportunity to serve God is a sacred trust.

Whether preaching, teaching, singing, counselling, visiting the sick, or helping others, believers are called to serve faithfully.

5. The Principle of Accountability

One of the most serious aspects of stewardship is accountability.

Stewards are responsible for how they manage what has been entrusted to them.

Romans 14:12

“So then every one of us shall give account of himself to God.”

Every believer will one day answer to God regarding:

- Time used or wasted.
- Talents developed or neglected.
- Resources managed or misused.
- Opportunities embraced or ignored.
- Relationships nurtured or damaged.

The Parable of the Talents

In **Matthew 25:14–30**, Jesus tells of servants entrusted with different amounts of money.

When the master returned, each servant had to give an account.

The faithful servants were rewarded because they used what they had received wisely.

The unfaithful servant was judged because he neglected his responsibility.

Lesson

God does not expect equal results from everyone, but He does expect faithfulness from everyone.

6. Characteristics of a Faithful Steward

Faithfulness

A steward consistently obeys God and fulfils responsibilities.

1 Corinthians 4:2

“It is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.”

Integrity

A steward acts honestly even when no one is watching.

Proverbs 10:9

“He that walketh uprightly walketh surely.”

Responsibility

A steward takes ownership of assigned duties and fulfils them diligently.

Humility

A steward remembers that all success comes from God.

James 4:10

“Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and he shall lift you up.”

Obedience

A steward follows the instructions of the Owner.

John 14:15

“If ye love me, keep my commandments.”

Benefits of Understanding Stewardship

When believers understand stewardship:

- They become more faithful in serving God.
 - They develop contentment and gratitude.
 - They avoid pride and selfishness.
 - They use resources wisely.
 - They honour God in every area of life.
 - They prepare for eternal rewards.
-

Practical Applications

1. Acknowledge daily that everything belongs to God.
 2. Evaluate how you use your time each week.
 3. Identify gifts and talents God has given you.
 4. Manage finances responsibly and honestly.
 5. Serve faithfully in every ministry assignment.
 6. Remember that you will one day give an account to God.
-

Case Study

Samuel inherited a family business. He considered it entirely his own and rarely prayed about how to use its profits. After studying stewardship, he realized that God was the true Owner and decided to support missions, help needy families, and run his business with integrity.

Questions

1. What misunderstanding did Samuel have about ownership?
 2. How did his perspective change?
 3. In what practical ways can believers honour God with their possessions?
-

Discussion Questions

1. What is the difference between ownership and stewardship?
 2. Why is recognizing God's ownership important?
 3. What resources has God entrusted to you?
 4. How does accountability affect the way we live?
 5. What qualities characterize a faithful steward?
-

Chapter Summary

Biblical stewardship begins with the recognition that God owns everything and believers are merely managers of His resources. God has entrusted us with time, talents, finances, relationships, opportunities, and ministry responsibilities. As stewards, we are accountable to Him and are called to manage His gifts faithfully, responsibly, and for His glory.

Key Lesson

God owns everything, and we are accountable stewards entrusted with managing His resources faithfully for His glory and Kingdom purposes.

CHAPTER 2

Stewardship of Time

Memory Verse

Ephesians 5:16

“Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.” (KJV)

Introduction

Time is one of the most precious resources God has entrusted to humanity. Unlike money, possessions, or opportunities, time cannot be stored, recovered, borrowed, or replaced once it has passed. Every person receives the same twenty-four hours each day, yet the difference between a fruitful life and an unproductive one is often determined by how that time is used.

God has given each believer a limited number of days on earth. Therefore, time should be viewed as a sacred gift and a divine responsibility. Every moment provides an opportunity to worship God, serve others, grow spiritually, fulfil responsibilities, and advance God's Kingdom.

Faithful stewards understand that time is not merely to be spent but invested wisely for eternal purposes.

1. Understanding Time as a Gift from God

Every day we live is evidence of God's grace and mercy.

Psalm 90:12

“So teach us to number our days, that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom.”

Moses prayed for wisdom to understand the brevity and value of life. Recognizing that our days are limited encourages us to live purposefully.

Many people postpone important decisions, delay obedience, and neglect spiritual growth because they assume they have unlimited time.

James 4:14

“For what is your life? It is even a vapour, that appeareth for a little time, and then vanisheth away.”

Life is temporary, and every day should be used wisely.

Key Truth

Time is a gift from God that should be invested wisely, not wasted carelessly.

2. Redeeming the Time

Ephesians 5:15–16

“See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil.”

Redeeming the time means making the best use of every opportunity.

Wise believers:

- Recognize opportunities to serve.
- Prioritize meaningful activities.
- Avoid wasting time.
- Use each day intentionally.

Foolish people often:

- Delay important tasks.
- Spend excessive time on distractions.
- Neglect spiritual responsibilities.
- Live without clear purpose.

Illustration

A farmer understands that planting must take place during the proper season. If he wastes the planting season, he may lose the harvest.

Likewise, believers must recognize and use opportunities before they pass.

Reflection

Ask yourself:

- Am I spending time on what truly matters?
 - Am I investing in eternal things or temporary pleasures?
-

3. Understanding God's Timing

Ecclesiastes 3:1

“To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven.”

God works according to seasons.

There is:

- A season to learn.
- A season to work.
- A season to build.
- A season to serve.
- A season to rest.
- A season to harvest.

Faithful stewards recognize God's timing and respond appropriately.

Biblical Example – Joseph

Joseph spent years as a servant and prisoner before becoming governor of Egypt.

Although God's promise was certain, Joseph had to wait for God's appointed time.

Lesson

Wisdom includes knowing not only what to do, but also when to do it.

4. Prioritizing God First

Matthew 6:33

“But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.”

One of the greatest principles of time stewardship is proper prioritization.

God must come first in our schedules, decisions, and daily activities.

Faithful stewards intentionally make time for:

- Prayer
- Bible study
- Worship
- Fellowship
- Evangelism
- Ministry service

Practical Ways to Put God First

- Begin each day with prayer.
- Read Scripture daily.
- Attend church faithfully.
- Participate in ministry.
- Seek God's guidance before making decisions.

Key Principle

When God is first in our lives, everything else finds its proper place.

5. Avoiding Laziness and Procrastination

Proverbs 6:6

“Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise.”

The ant works diligently and prepares for the future.

Lazy people often:

- Delay important tasks.
- Make excuses.
- Waste opportunities.
- Depend unnecessarily on others.

Proverbs 13:4

“The soul of the sluggard desireth, and hath nothing: but the soul of the diligent shall be made fat.”

Procrastination is another enemy of stewardship.

Common Causes of Procrastination

- Fear of failure
- Poor planning
- Lack of discipline
- Distractions
- Perfectionism

Overcoming Procrastination

- Set clear goals.
- Begin immediately.
- Break large tasks into smaller steps.
- Maintain discipline.
- Depend on God's help.

6. Planning and Organization

Proverbs 21:5

“The thoughts of the diligent tend only to plenteousness; but of every one that is hasty only to want.”

Planning helps believers:

- Use time effectively.
- Avoid confusion.
- Meet responsibilities.
- Accomplish goals.
- Reduce stress.

Practical Planning Tools

- Daily schedules
- Weekly planners
- Ministry calendars
- Goal-setting sheets
- Priority lists

Important Principle

Planning does not replace dependence on God; it helps us manage responsibilities wisely.

7. Balancing Life's Responsibilities

God expects believers to manage several responsibilities at the same time.

Spiritual Responsibilities

- Prayer
- Bible study
- Worship
- Evangelism

Family Responsibilities

- Marriage
- Parenting
- Family care

Work Responsibilities

- Employment
- Business
- Professional duties

Ministry Responsibilities

- Church service
- Leadership
- Discipleship

Neglecting one area while focusing entirely on another is poor stewardship.

Illustration

A person may become deeply involved in ministry while neglecting family responsibilities.

Another person may focus completely on career advancement while ignoring spiritual growth.

Faithful stewards seek balance under God's guidance.

8. Investing Time in Eternal Priorities

Colossians 3:2

“Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth.”

Wise believers invest time in activities that produce eternal value.

Examples include:

- Leading people to Christ
- Discipline believers
- Studying God's Word
- Prayer
- Serving others
- Building godly relationships

Many temporary activities consume time but leave little lasting impact.

Reflection

At the end of life, people seldom regret spending too much time serving God, loving family, or helping others.

They often regret wasted opportunities and neglected priorities.

Characteristics of a Good Time Steward

A faithful steward of time:

- Values every day as a gift from God.
 - Lives purposefully.
 - Prioritizes God first.
 - Avoids laziness.
 - Overcomes procrastination.
 - Plans wisely.
 - Maintains balance.
 - Invests in eternal things.
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Case Study

The Busy Church Worker

Peter faithfully attended every church meeting and ministry activity. However, his wife and children felt neglected because he rarely spent time with them.

Eventually, his family relationships became strained.

Peter realized that stewardship includes caring for family as well as serving in ministry.

Questions

1. What mistake did Peter make?
 2. Which responsibilities did he neglect?
 3. How can believers maintain balance between family, work, and ministry?
-

Practical Applications

1. Begin each day with prayer and Bible reading.
2. Create a daily schedule and follow it.

3. Identify and eliminate time-wasting habits.
 4. Set spiritual, family, and ministry goals.
 5. Complete important tasks promptly.
 6. Review each week and evaluate how your time was spent.
 7. Invest more time in activities with eternal value.
-

Discussion Questions

1. Why is time considered one of God's greatest gifts?
 2. What does it mean to redeem the time?
 3. What are some common ways people waste time?
 4. How can believers put God first in their schedules?
 5. What practical steps can improve time management?
 6. How can a person balance family, work, and ministry responsibilities?
-

Chapter Summary

Time is a precious gift entrusted to us by God. Since life is temporary, believers must use their time wisely by seeking God first, recognizing opportunities, avoiding laziness, planning effectively, and maintaining balance in their responsibilities.

Faithful stewards understand that every day is an opportunity to glorify God and advance His Kingdom. They invest their time in things that have lasting spiritual value and seek to make every moment count for eternity.

Key Lesson

Faithful stewards value their time as a gift from God and use it wisely to fulfil His purposes, serve others, and advance His Kingdom.

CHAPTER 3

Stewardship of Talents and Gifts

Memory Verse

1 Peter 4:10

“As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God.” (KJV)

Introduction

God has uniquely designed every believer and entrusted each person with talents, abilities, and spiritual gifts. These gifts are not given for personal glory, competition, or self-promotion, but for serving others and advancing God's Kingdom.

No believer is without a gift, and no gift is insignificant in God's sight. Just as different parts of the human body perform different functions, believers have different gifts and responsibilities within the Body of Christ.

Some are called to teach, others to lead, encourage, serve, give, organize, sing, evangelize, show mercy, or shepherd God's people. When every believer faithfully uses his or her God-given gifts, the church grows stronger and God's purposes are fulfilled.

Unfortunately, many believers neglect their gifts, underestimate them, misuse them, or compare themselves to others. God expects His children to discover, develop, and diligently use what He has entrusted to them.

The question is not whether you have a gift, but whether you are using it faithfully.

1. Understanding Talents and Spiritual Gifts

Although talents and spiritual gifts are related, they are not exactly the same.

Talents

Talents are natural abilities God has given to individuals.

Examples include:

- Singing
- Writing
- Leadership
- Teaching
- Administration
- Art and design
- Communication
- Business skills
- Technology skills
- Craftsmanship

These abilities may appear early in life and can be improved through learning and practice.

Spiritual Gifts

Spiritual gifts are special abilities given by the Holy Spirit to believers for ministry and service.

Examples include:

- Teaching
- Prophecy
- Encouragement
- Leadership
- Giving
- Mercy
- Evangelism
- Pastoring
- Discernment
- Helps

Romans 12:6

“Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us.”

God distributes gifts according to His wisdom and purpose.

Key Truth

Every believer has something valuable to contribute to God's Kingdom.

2. God Is the Source of Every Gift

All gifts originate from God.

James 1:17

“Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from the Father of lights.”

No talent, intelligence, opportunity, or spiritual gift is self-created.

Everything we possess has been given by God.

Recognizing this truth produces:

- Humility
- Gratitude
- Dependence upon God

Pride develops when people forget the source of their abilities and begin taking credit for what God has provided.

1 Corinthians 4:7

“For who maketh thee to differ from another? and what hast thou that thou didst not receive?”

Lesson

Because God is the source of every gift, He deserves all the glory.

3. Every Gift Has Value

Many believers wrongly believe that only visible gifts are important.

Scripture teaches otherwise.

1 Corinthians 12:18

“But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.”

Some gifts are public.

Others operate quietly behind the scenes.

Visible Gifts

- Preaching
- Teaching
- Worship leading
- Evangelism

Less Visible Gifts

- Administration
- Hospitality
- Intercession
- Encouragement
- Service and helps

Both categories are equally important.

Illustration

The heart is rarely seen, yet it is essential for life.

Likewise, many people serving quietly behind the scenes play indispensable roles in God's Kingdom.

Key Principle

God measures faithfulness, not visibility.

4. Discovering Your Gifts

Many believers never discover their gifts because they never seek God's direction or become involved in serving.

A. Pray for God's Guidance

Ask God to reveal the gifts and abilities He has placed within you.

James 1:5

“If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God.”

B. Study God's Word

The Bible identifies various spiritual gifts and ministry functions.

Important passages include:

- Romans 12:3–8
 - 1 Corinthians 12
 - Ephesians 4:11–12
 - 1 Peter 4:10–11
-

C. Begin Serving

Many gifts are discovered through practical ministry involvement.

As you serve:

- Your strengths become evident.
- Others recognize your effectiveness.
- Opportunities for growth emerge.

D. Seek Wise Counsel

Church leaders and mature believers can often identify gifts you may not recognize in yourself.

Proverbs 15:22

“Without counsel purposes are disappointed: but in the multitude of counsellors they are established.”

5. Developing Your Gifts

Possessing a gift is only the beginning.

Gifts must be developed through practice, learning, and diligence.

2 Timothy 1:6

“Stir up the gift of God, which is in thee.”

Paul encouraged Timothy not to neglect his gift but to strengthen and develop it.

Ways to Develop Your Gifts

Study and Training

Learn from Scripture, mentors, books, and educational opportunities.

Practice Regularly

Growth comes through consistent use.

Accept Correction

Constructive feedback helps improve effectiveness.

Remain Teachable

The most effective servants are lifelong learners.

Illustration

A seed contains great potential, but unless it is planted, watered, and nurtured, it will never reach maturity.

Lesson

Unused gifts remain undeveloped gifts.

6. Using Gifts to Serve Others

1 Peter 4:10

“As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another.”

The purpose of spiritual gifts is service.

God did not give gifts merely for personal benefit but for helping others and strengthening His church.

Ways Gifts Serve Others

- Teaching brings understanding.
- Encouragement brings hope.
- Leadership provides direction.
- Giving meets needs.
- Mercy brings comfort.
- Evangelism brings salvation.

Key Principle

Gifts are tools for service, not trophies for display.

7. The Danger of Neglecting Gifts

Many believers possess gifts that remain unused.

Matthew 25:25

In the Parable of the Talents, one servant buried what had been entrusted to him.

The master rebuked him because he failed to use his opportunity.

Reasons People Neglect Their Gifts

- Fear
- Laziness
- Lack of confidence
- Comparison with others
- Discouragement
- Lack of commitment

Neglected gifts fail to produce fruit and blessings.

Lesson

God expects believers to use what He has entrusted to them.

8. Avoiding Comparison and Competition

One of the greatest enemies of effective stewardship is comparison.

Galatians 6:4

“But let every man prove his own work.”

Comparison often leads to:

- Jealousy
- Pride
- Discouragement
- Competition

God never intended all believers to possess identical gifts.

Romans 12:6

“Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us.”

Important Truth

Your value is not determined by the type of gift you possess but by your faithfulness in using it.

9. The Principle of Growth and Multiplication

Matthew 25:29

“For unto every one that hath shall be given.”

God often increases opportunities for those who faithfully use what they already have.

Faithfulness leads to:

- Greater influence
- Greater opportunities
- Greater responsibility
- Greater effectiveness

Principle

Use it or lose it.

Characteristics of a Faithful Steward of Gifts

A faithful steward:

- Recognizes God as the source of every gift.
- Appreciates the value of all gifts.
- Seeks to discover God's purpose.
- Develops abilities diligently.
- Uses gifts to serve others.
- Avoids pride and comparison.
- Remains teachable.
- Gives God all the glory.

Case Study

The Hidden Musician

Sarah had a beautiful singing voice but refused to join the worship team because she feared criticism.

For years, her gift remained unused.

Eventually, she decided to trust God and serve faithfully. Her ministry encouraged many people and inspired other young believers to use their gifts.

Questions

1. What prevented Sarah from using her gift?
 2. What changed when she began serving?
 3. What gifts might God be calling you to use?
-

Practical Applications

1. Identify talents and gifts God has given you.
 2. Begin serving where opportunities exist.
 3. Seek training and development.
 4. Ask trusted leaders for feedback.
 5. Avoid comparing yourself with others.
 6. Commit to using your gifts consistently.
 7. Give God glory for every success.
-

Discussion Questions

1. What is the difference between a natural talent and a spiritual gift?
2. Why does God give different gifts to different people?
3. How can believers discover their gifts?
4. What happens when gifts are neglected?

5. Why is comparison dangerous?
 6. How can gifts be developed and strengthened?
-

Chapter Summary

God has given every believer unique talents, abilities, and spiritual gifts for the purpose of serving others and glorifying Him.

Since God is the source of every gift, believers must use them with humility and gratitude.

Faithful stewards discover, develop, and diligently use their gifts rather than neglecting them.

When gifts are properly used, the church is strengthened, lives are transformed, and God receives glory.

Key Lesson

Every gift from God is valuable and should be faithfully developed and used to serve others, build God's Kingdom, and bring glory to Him.

CHAPTER 4

Stewardship of Financial Resources

Memory Verse

Proverbs 3:9

“Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase.” (KJV)

Introduction

Money and material possessions are among the resources God entrusts to His people. While finances are necessary for daily living, the Bible teaches that money is more than a means of exchange—it is a test of character, faithfulness, and priorities.

The way believers earn, spend, save, give, and manage their finances reveals much about their relationship with God.

Financial stewardship is not measured by how much a person possesses but by how faithfully he or she manages what has been entrusted by God. Whether one has little or much, God expects wisdom, honesty, responsibility, and generosity.

Throughout Scripture, God provides principles for managing resources in ways that honour Him and advance His Kingdom.

Many financial difficulties arise not because of a lack of resources but because of poor stewardship. God desires His people to become faithful managers who use financial resources for His glory and the blessing of others.

1. Understanding God's Ownership of Wealth

The foundation of financial stewardship begins with recognizing that God owns everything.

Psalms 24:1

“The earth is the LORD'S, and the fullness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.”

Everything we possess ultimately belongs to God.

God owns:

- Our income
- Our property
- Our businesses
- Our investments
- Our possessions

We are not owners but stewards entrusted with God's resources.

Deuteronomy 8:18

“But thou shalt remember the LORD thy God: for it is he that giveth thee power to get wealth.”

Even our skills, opportunities, strength, and knowledge come from Him.

Key Truth

God is the Owner; we are the managers.

2. Earning Money Honestly

God desires believers to obtain resources through honest and honourable means.

Proverbs 13:11

“Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished: but he that gathereth by labour shall increase.”

The Bible condemns:

- Fraud
- Theft
- Corruption
- Dishonesty
- Bribery
- Exploitation

Believers are encouraged to work diligently and honestly.

Colossians 3:23

“And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men.”

Characteristics of Honest Earning

- Integrity in business
- Fair treatment of others
- Truthfulness in transactions
- Excellence in work
- Dependability

Lesson

God blesses honest labour more than dishonest gain.

3. Faithfulness in Small Things

Luke 16:10

“He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much.”

One of God's principles is that faithfulness in small matters prepares a person for greater responsibility.

Many people pray for financial increase while neglecting proper management of what they already possess.

Faithfulness includes:

- Paying bills on time
- Keeping financial records
- Avoiding waste
- Honouring commitments
- Managing resources carefully

Principle

God often tests our stewardship before increasing our resources.

4. Honouring God with Our Wealth

Proverbs 3:9

“Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase.”

Financial stewardship begins by placing God first.

Many people spend money on everything else and give God whatever remains. Scripture teaches the opposite principle.

Honouring God with wealth means:

- Recognizing Him as the source
- Giving Him priority
- Using finances according to His purposes
- Avoiding greed and selfishness

Practical Ways to Honour God Financially

- Support God's work
- Help those in need
- Practice honesty
- Avoid wasteful spending
- Maintain a generous spirit

Key Principle

Where God is honoured, His blessing often follows.

5. The Principle of Tithing

Malachi 3:10

“Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse...”

The tithe refers to giving one-tenth of one's increase to God.

Throughout Scripture, tithing is presented as an act of:

- Worship
- Obedience
- Faith
- Gratitude

Tithing reminds believers that everything belongs to God and that He is their Provider.

Benefits of Tithing

- Demonstrates trust in God
- Supports ministry work
- Develops financial discipline
- Breaks the power of greed
- Expresses gratitude

Important Note

Tithing should never be viewed as a burden but as an opportunity to honour God.

6. The Ministry of Generous Giving

2 Corinthians 9:7

“God loveth a cheerful giver.”

Beyond tithing, believers are encouraged to practice generosity.

Generous giving reflects the character of God, who freely gives to His children.

Areas of Generosity

- Supporting church ministry
- Helping the poor
- Assisting widows and orphans
- Supporting missionaries
- Meeting urgent needs
- Blessing others

Characteristics of Biblical Giving

Willing

Giving should come from the heart.

Cheerful

Giving should be done joyfully.

Sacrificial

Sometimes generosity requires personal sacrifice.

Faith-Filled

Giving demonstrates trust in God's provision.

Acts 20:35

“It is more blessed to give than to receive.”

7. Wise Spending

Proverbs 21:20

“There is treasure to be desired and oil in the dwelling of the wise; but a foolish man spendeth it up.”

Many financial difficulties arise from poor spending habits rather than insufficient income.

Principles of Wise Spending

- Distinguish needs from wants
- Avoid impulsive purchases
- Live within your means
- Plan purchases carefully

- Seek God's guidance

Questions Before Spending

Ask yourself:

- Is this necessary?
- Will this honour God?
- Can I afford it?
- Is this the best use of my resources?

Lesson

Wise spending reflects disciplined stewardship.

8. Saving and Planning for the Future

Proverbs 6:6–8

“Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise.”

The ant gathers and stores resources for future needs.

Saving demonstrates:

- Wisdom
- Responsibility
- Foresight
- Discipline

Reasons for Saving

- Emergencies
- Future goals
- Family responsibilities

- Ministry opportunities

Balance

While saving is wise, believers should avoid trusting money more than God.

Key Principle

Save responsibly while trusting God completely.

9. Avoiding Unnecessary Debt

Proverbs 22:7

“The borrower is servant to the lender.”

Although not all debt is sinful, unnecessary debt can become a burden.

Causes of Excessive Debt

- Impulse buying
- Poor planning
- Greed
- Lack of contentment
- Living beyond one's means

Biblical Financial Wisdom

- Borrow cautiously
- Repay debts promptly
- Avoid unnecessary obligations
- Practice contentment

Romans 13:8

“Owe no man any thing, but to love one another.”

10. Guarding Against Greed and Materialism

Matthew 6:24

“Ye cannot serve God and mammon.”

Money is a useful servant but a terrible master.

Signs of Materialism

- Constant dissatisfaction
- Obsession with wealth
- Neglect of spiritual priorities
- Excessive focus on possessions

1 Timothy 6:10

“For the love of money is the root of all evil.”

The Bible does not condemn money itself but warns against loving it more than God.

Lesson

God desires us to possess resources without allowing resources to possess us.

11. Financial Stewardship in Church Ministry

Church leaders and workers have a special responsibility to model financial integrity.

Responsibilities Include

- Accountability in handling church funds
- Transparency in financial matters
- Avoiding misuse of ministry resources
- Maintaining accurate records
- Demonstrating generosity

1 Corinthians 4:2

“Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.”

Faithfulness in finances strengthens trust and protects the testimony of the church.

Characteristics of a Faithful Financial Steward

A faithful steward:

- Recognizes God as Owner.
 - Earns honestly.
 - Honours God first.
 - Tithes faithfully.
 - Gives generously.
 - Spends wisely.
 - Saves responsibly.
 - Avoids unnecessary debt.
 - Lives with contentment.
 - Uses resources for God's glory.
-

Case Study

The Salary Increase

John received a promotion at work that doubled his income.

At first, he thanked God and increased his giving. However, after several months, he purchased expensive items he did not need, stopped tithing, and accumulated debt.

Soon he experienced financial stress.

After prayer and counsel, John created a budget, resumed faithful giving, and began managing his finances wisely.

Questions

1. What stewardship principles did John neglect?
 2. How did his financial decisions affect his spiritual life?
 3. What practical steps helped him recover?
-

Practical Applications

1. Prepare and follow a monthly budget.
 2. Commit to honouring God with your finances.
 3. Practice regular tithing and generous giving.
 4. Reduce unnecessary spending.
 5. Establish a savings plan.
 6. Avoid taking on unnecessary debt.
 7. Review your financial habits regularly.
 8. Use resources to bless others and advance God's Kingdom.
-

Discussion Questions

1. Why is financial stewardship important to God?
 2. What does it mean to honour God with your wealth?
 3. How does tithing demonstrate faith and obedience?
 4. What are the dangers of excessive debt?
 5. How can believers guard against materialism?
 6. What practical steps can improve financial stewardship?
-

Chapter Summary

Financial resources are gifts entrusted to believers by God. Since God is the Owner of all things, believers are called to manage money with wisdom, integrity, and faithfulness.

Good stewardship involves earning honestly, honouring God first, tithing faithfully, giving generously, spending wisely, saving responsibly, and avoiding unnecessary debt.

Faithful financial stewardship not only brings stability and blessing but also advances God's Kingdom and reflects a heart that trusts God above material possessions.

Key Lesson

God expects believers to manage financial resources faithfully by earning honestly, giving generously, spending wisely, and using every resource for His glory and Kingdom purposes.

CHAPTER 5

Stewardship of Relationships

Memory Verse

Romans 12:10

“Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another.” (KJV)

Introduction

Relationships are among the greatest gifts God entrusts to His people. From the beginning of creation, God declared that it was not good for man to be alone. He created human beings for fellowship with Himself and with one another.

Every relationship in our lives is a trust from God. Family members, spouses, children, friends, church members, neighbours, colleagues, and even strangers are people whom God has placed within our sphere of influence. As stewards, believers are responsible for nurturing healthy relationships that reflect the character of Christ.

Many people focus on managing money, possessions, and opportunities while neglecting relationships. Yet broken relationships often bring pain, division, and spiritual stagnation. Faithful stewardship includes treating others with love, kindness, respect, forgiveness, and integrity.

Jesus demonstrated perfect stewardship of relationships. He invested time in His disciples, showed compassion to the needy, forgave sinners, and loved people sacrificially. Believers are called to follow His example.

Key Truth

People are gifts from God and should be loved, valued, and cared for as faithful stewards of His grace.

1. Relationships Are Gifts from God

God designed human beings to live in fellowship.

Genesis 2:18

“And the LORD God said, It is not good that the man should be alone.”

Relationships are part of God's provision for our lives.

God blesses us through:

- Family members
- Marriage partners
- Children
- Friends
- Church members
- Mentors
- Co-workers

Every relationship should be viewed as a sacred trust.

Lesson

Faithful stewards value people more than possessions.

2. Stewardship Within the Family

The family is one of God's greatest institutions.

Believers are called to manage family relationships with wisdom, love, and responsibility.

Ephesians 5:25

“Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church.”

Responsibilities of Husbands

- Love sacrificially
- Lead spiritually
- Provide for the family
- Protect and encourage

Responsibilities of Wives

Ephesians 5:22

“Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord.”

- Support their husbands
- Build the home
- Nurture relationships
- Demonstrate wisdom and kindness

Responsibilities of Parents

Proverbs 22:6

“Train up a child in the way he should go.”

Parents should:

- Teach God's Word
- Discipline lovingly
- Spend quality time with children
- Model godly character

Responsibilities of Children

Ephesians 6:1

“Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.”

Children honour God by respecting and obeying their parents.

3. Stewardship of Friendships

Friendships influence character, decisions, and spiritual growth.

Proverbs 13:20

“He that walketh with wise men shall be wise.”

Good friendships provide:

- Encouragement
- Accountability
- Support
- Wisdom
- Fellowship

Believers should choose friends wisely.

Characteristics of Godly Friends

- Honest
- Loyal
- Encouraging
- Trustworthy
- Spiritually minded

Proverbs 17:17

“A friend loveth at all times.”

Lesson

Faithful stewards cultivate friendships that strengthen faith and character.

4. Stewardship in the Church Family

The church is the household of God.

Believers are members of one body and are called to live in unity.

Romans 12:5

“So we, being many, are one body in Christ.”

Ways believers can steward church relationships include:

- Encouraging one another
- Praying for one another
- Supporting ministry efforts
- Avoiding gossip
- Showing hospitality
- Serving together

Hebrews 10:24–25

“And let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good works.”

Key Principle

Healthy churches are built through healthy relationships.

5. The Stewardship of Speech

Words have the power to heal or to wound.

Proverbs 18:21

“Death and life are in the power of the tongue.”

Faithful stewards guard their speech.

Believers should speak words that:

- Encourage
- Comfort
- Teach
- Correct lovingly
- Build up others

Believers should avoid:

- Gossip
- Slander
- Harsh criticism
- Lies
- Complaining

Ephesians 4:29

“Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth.”

Lesson

Wise words preserve relationships and glorify God.

6. Practicing Forgiveness

No relationship remains healthy without forgiveness.

People sometimes disappoint, offend, or hurt us.

Jesus taught His followers to forgive as they have been forgiven.

Colossians 3:13

“Forgiving one another, even as Christ forgave you.”

Forgiveness:

- Restores fellowship
- Brings healing
- Releases bitterness
- Reflects God's mercy

Forgiveness does not always erase consequences, but it frees the heart from resentment.

Illustration

Joseph forgave his brothers even after they sold him into slavery.

Instead of seeking revenge, he chose mercy.

Genesis 50:20

“But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good.”

7. Resolving Conflict Biblically

Disagreements are inevitable, but they should be handled in a godly manner.

Matthew 5:9

“Blessed are the peacemakers.”

Biblical principles for resolving conflict include:

- Address problems promptly
- Speak truth in love
- Listen carefully
- Pray together
- Seek reconciliation
- Involve wise counsel when necessary

Romans 12:18

“If it be possible, as much as lieth in you, live peaceably with all men.”

Key Principle

Faithful stewards pursue peace rather than division.

8. Serving Others Through Relationships

Jesus used relationships to minister to people.

He visited homes, ate with sinners, comforted the grieving, and taught His disciples.

Believers should intentionally invest in people.

Practical ways include:

- Visiting the sick
- Encouraging the lonely
- Mentoring younger believers
- Supporting struggling families
- Praying for friends
- Showing hospitality

Galatians 6:2

“Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.”

Characteristics of a Faithful Steward of Relationships

A faithful steward:

- Values people as gifts from God.
 - Loves sacrificially.
 - Speaks kindly.
 - Forgives readily.
 - Resolves conflicts peacefully.
 - Encourages others.
 - Builds healthy families.
 - Serves the church faithfully.
 - Maintains integrity.
 - Reflects the character of Christ.
-

Case Study

The Church Disagreement

Two ministry leaders disagreed over how a church event should be organized.

Instead of discussing the issue privately, they spoke negatively about one another to other members.

The disagreement spread and created division within the church.

Eventually, both leaders met with the pastor, apologized, forgave one another, and restored their friendship.

Questions

1. What mistakes did these leaders make?
 2. How could the conflict have been resolved earlier?
 3. Why is forgiveness essential in Christian relationships?
-

Practical Applications

1. Pray regularly for your family members.
 2. Spend meaningful time with loved ones.
 3. Encourage someone each day.
 4. Guard your speech carefully.
 5. Seek reconciliation quickly when conflicts arise.
 6. Practice forgiveness consistently.
 7. Invest time in building godly friendships.
 8. Support and strengthen relationships within the church.
-

Discussion Questions

1. Why are relationships considered gifts from God?

2. How can believers become better stewards of their families?
 3. What qualities characterize a godly friendship?
 4. Why is forgiveness important in stewardship?
 5. How should Christians handle conflicts?
 6. In what ways can believers strengthen relationships within the church?
-

Chapter Summary

God has entrusted believers with relationships that are to be managed with love, wisdom, humility, and integrity. Faithful stewards recognize that people are more valuable than possessions and intentionally nurture healthy relationships within their families, friendships, workplaces, and churches.

By practicing forgiveness, speaking graciously, resolving conflicts biblically, and serving others sacrificially, believers reflect the character of Christ and become channels of God's grace to those around them.

Key Lesson

Faithful stewards honour God by building healthy relationships, practicing forgiveness, serving others, and treating people as valuable gifts entrusted to them by God.

CHAPTER 6

Stewardship of Opportunities

Memory Verse

Galatians 6:10

“As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith.”
(KJV)

Introduction

Life is filled with opportunities that God places before His people. These opportunities may come in the form of ministry assignments, acts of service, relationships, education, employment, leadership positions, witnessing opportunities, or moments to help those in need.

Every opportunity carries the potential to fulfil God's purposes and bring glory to His name.

Many people pray for opportunities, yet when opportunities come, they fail to recognize them or delay responding until it is too late. The Bible teaches that opportunities are gifts from God and must be managed wisely. Just as believers are stewards of time, talents, finances, and relationships, they are also stewards of opportunities.

Faithful believers understand that opportunities often come disguised as responsibilities, challenges, or simple acts of obedience. They remain spiritually alert, sensitive to God's leading, and willing to act when God opens a door.

A missed opportunity may never return, while a seized opportunity can change lives, impact generations, and advance God's Kingdom.

Key Truth

Every God-given opportunity is a responsibility that should be managed faithfully.

1. Understanding Opportunities as Gifts from God

Opportunities do not happen by accident.

God, in His sovereignty, opens doors and creates circumstances through which His purposes can be accomplished.

Revelation 3:8

“Behold, I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it.”

Throughout Scripture, God presented opportunities to individuals and nations.

Examples include:

- Noah's opportunity to build the ark.
- Moses' opportunity to lead Israel.
- Esther's opportunity to save her people.
- David's opportunity to defeat Goliath.
- Paul's opportunity to preach the Gospel to the Gentiles.

Each person faced a choice:

Would they embrace the opportunity or ignore it?

Lesson

Every opportunity from God carries both privilege and responsibility.

2. Recognizing Opportunities

Many opportunities are missed because people fail to recognize them.

Galatians 6:10

“As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men.”

Opportunities often appear as:

- A chance to serve
- A person in need
- A ministry assignment
- A leadership responsibility
- A learning experience
- A challenge requiring faith

Some people expect opportunities to arrive dramatically and fail to notice ordinary moments that God can use for extraordinary purposes.

Illustration

The Good Samaritan recognized an opportunity to help an injured traveller when others walked past.

His compassion transformed a simple moment into a lasting example of godly stewardship.

Key Principle

Spiritual sensitivity helps believers recognize opportunities others may overlook.

3. Making the Most of Every Opportunity

Colossians 4:5

“Walk in wisdom toward them that are without, redeeming the time.”

Making the most of every opportunity means taking full advantage of the doors God opens.

Faithful stewards:

- Act promptly.
- Remain prepared.
- Respond wisely.
- Avoid unnecessary delays.

Many opportunities are time-sensitive.

Delayed obedience can become disobedience.

Illustration

A farmer who refuses to plant during planting season may miss the harvest.

Likewise, opportunities often have a limited season and require immediate action.

Lesson

Opportunities are valuable because they do not last forever.

4. Opportunities to Serve Others

One of the greatest opportunities believers receive is the privilege of serving others.

Mark 10:45

“For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister.”

Service opportunities may include:

- Helping the needy
- Encouraging the discouraged
- Visiting the sick
- Supporting church projects
- Mentoring younger believers
- Assisting elderly people
- Participating in community outreach

Faithful stewards do not wait for perfect circumstances.

They serve whenever opportunities arise.

Lesson

Serving others is one of the clearest expressions of faithful stewardship.

5. Opportunities to Share the Gospel

One of the most important opportunities believers receive is the opportunity to witness.

Matthew 28:19

“Go ye therefore, and teach all nations.”

Every day presents opportunities to:

- Share personal testimonies
- Invite others to church
- Explain the message of salvation
- Pray with those in need
- Demonstrate Christ's love

Many people may only have one opportunity to hear the Gospel.

Romans 10:14

“How shall they hear without a preacher?”

Key Principle

Faithful stewards seize opportunities to bring others closer to Christ.

6. Opportunities for Growth and Learning

God often provides opportunities for believers to grow spiritually, emotionally, intellectually, and professionally.

Proverbs 1:5

“A wise man will hear, and will increase learning.”

Growth opportunities include:

- Bible study
- Ministry training
- Mentorship

- Conferences and seminars
- Educational advancement
- Leadership development
- Ministry experience

Some people reject opportunities because they require sacrifice, effort, or change.

Wise believers understand that growth often comes through challenges.

Biblical Example

Timothy matured in ministry because he embraced opportunities to learn from Paul.

Lesson

Every opportunity to learn is an opportunity to increase effectiveness.

7. Opportunities Hidden in Challenges

Not all opportunities appear pleasant at first.

Many of God's greatest opportunities come disguised as difficulties.

Romans 8:28

“And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God.”

Examples include:

- Joseph's imprisonment became an opportunity for promotion.
- David's battle with Goliath became an opportunity for advancement.
- Paul's imprisonment became an opportunity to spread the Gospel.

Challenges often:

- Build character
- Strengthen faith
- Develop leadership
- Reveal hidden potential

Lesson

Faithful stewards learn to see possibilities where others only see problems.

8. Working Diligently While Opportunities Remain

John 9:4

“I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work.”

Jesus emphasized urgency.

Opportunities are not permanent.

There are seasons for:

- Serving
- Learning
- Witnessing

- Building
- Giving
- Growing

When these seasons pass, opportunities may disappear.

Ecclesiastes 9:10

“Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might.”

Important Principle

The best time to obey God is now.

9. Common Reasons People Miss Opportunities

Fear

Fear of failure often prevents action.

Proverbs 29:25

“The fear of man bringeth a snare.”

Procrastination

Waiting too long causes many opportunities to disappear.

Lack of Preparation

Unprepared people often miss open doors.

Laziness

Some opportunities require effort and sacrifice.

Disobedience

Ignoring God's direction often results in missed blessings.

Lesson

Faithfulness requires courage, readiness, and action.

10. The Rewards of Seizing Opportunities

When believers faithfully respond to opportunities:

God Is Glorified

Lives reflect His goodness and power.

Others Are Blessed

People receive help, encouragement, and salvation.

Character Is Developed

Faith grows through obedience.

Greater Opportunities Follow

Faithfulness in small opportunities often leads to larger responsibilities.

Matthew 25:21

“Well done, thou good and faithful servant.”

Key Truth

God often entrusts greater opportunities to those who faithfully use smaller ones.

Characteristics of a Faithful Steward of Opportunities

A faithful steward:

- Remains spiritually alert.
 - Recognizes God's open doors.
 - Acts promptly.
 - Serves willingly.
 - Shares the Gospel boldly.
 - Embraces growth opportunities.
 - Perseveres through challenges.
 - Works diligently.
 - Trusts God's timing.
 - Uses every opportunity for God's glory.
-

Case Study

Esther's Moment

Esther was placed in the palace for a purpose she did not fully understand.

When the Jewish people faced destruction, Mordecai reminded her:

Esther 4:14

“And who knoweth whether thou art come to the kingdom for such a time as this?”

Esther chose courage over fear and used her position to save her people.

Questions

1. What opportunity did Esther receive?
 2. What risks did she face?
 3. How did her obedience affect an entire nation?
 4. What opportunities might God be placing before you today?
-

Practical Applications

1. Pray daily for wisdom to recognize opportunities.
 2. Be willing to serve whenever needs arise.
 3. Share your faith when opportunities present themselves.
 4. Participate in learning and training opportunities.
 5. Stop delaying important actions.
 6. View challenges as potential opportunities.
 7. Act quickly when God opens a door.
 8. Review each day and identify opportunities you used or missed.
-

Discussion Questions

1. What is a God-given opportunity?
2. Why do many people fail to recognize opportunities?
3. How can believers make the most of every opportunity?
4. What opportunities has God recently placed before you?

5. How can challenges become opportunities?
 6. Why is urgency important in stewardship?
-

Chapter Summary

God continually provides opportunities for believers to serve, witness, grow, learn, and bless others. These opportunities are valuable gifts that must be recognized and used before they pass.

Faithful stewards remain spiritually alert, act promptly, and respond obediently when God opens doors. Whether opportunities come through ministry, relationships, service, learning, or challenges, believers are called to use them for God's glory and the advancement of His Kingdom.

Key Lesson

Faithful stewards recognize, embrace, and maximize God-given opportunities to serve others, grow spiritually, advance God's Kingdom, and bring glory to Him.

CHAPTER 7

Rewards of Faithful Stewardship

Memory Verse

Matthew 25:21

“His lord said unto him, Well done, thou good and faithful servant: thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.” (KJV)

Introduction

Throughout this course, we have learned that stewardship involves faithfully managing everything God has entrusted to us—our time, talents, finances, relationships, opportunities, spiritual gifts, and responsibilities.

Stewardship is not merely about managing resources; it is about honouring God through faithful obedience.

One of the greatest motivations for faithful stewardship is the assurance that God sees, values, and rewards faithfulness. While people often reward success, popularity, wealth, or achievement, God rewards faithfulness.

The Bible repeatedly teaches that no act of obedience, sacrifice, service, or generosity done for God is ever overlooked.

Many faithful believers may never receive recognition on earth. Their service may go unnoticed by others, but God keeps a perfect record. He sees every prayer prayed, every sacrifice made, every gift given, every soul reached, and every act of service performed in His name.

The ultimate goal of stewardship is not earthly recognition but hearing the words of Christ:

“Well done, good and faithful servant.”
(*Matthew 25:21*)

This chapter explores the blessings and rewards that accompany faithful stewardship both in this life and in eternity.

1. God Rewards Faithfulness, Not Merely Results

Matthew 25:21

“Well done, thou good and faithful servant.”

In the Parable of the Talents, the master rewarded his servants because they had been faithful with what was entrusted to them.

The reward was not based upon comparison.

God does not expect every believer to have the same:

- Position
- Influence
- Resources
- Opportunities
- Results

However, He expects every believer to be faithful with what they have received.

Key Truth

God measures faithfulness, not fame.

Lesson

Success in God's eyes is faithfully fulfilling His purpose for your life.

2. Faithfulness in Small Things Leads to Greater Responsibility

Luke 16:10

“He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much.”

One of God's principles is that faithfulness in small responsibilities prepares a person for greater opportunities.

Many believers desire greater influence, leadership, and blessings while neglecting smaller assignments.

Examples of small areas of stewardship include:

- Managing personal finances
- Serving in simple ministry tasks
- Keeping commitments
- Arriving on time
- Caring for church property
- Helping others quietly

God often tests character through small assignments before entrusting larger responsibilities.

Biblical Examples

Joseph

Joseph faithfully served as a slave and prisoner before becoming governor of Egypt.

David

David faithfully cared for sheep before becoming king.

Timothy

Timothy faithfully assisted Paul before becoming a respected church leader.

Principle

Small acts of faithfulness prepare us for greater Kingdom assignments.

3. The Reward of Spiritual Growth

Faithful stewardship produces spiritual maturity.

As believers consistently obey God, they develop:

- Stronger faith
- Greater wisdom
- Better character
- Increased humility
- Deeper trust in God

James 1:3–4

“Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.”

Every act of faithful stewardship shapes believers into the image of Christ.

Areas of Growth

Growth in Character

Faithfulness develops integrity and discipline.

Growth in Faith

Trusting God with resources strengthens confidence in Him.

Growth in Wisdom

Wise stewardship increases spiritual understanding.

Growth in Dependence on God

Faithful stewards learn that success comes from God rather than personal ability.

Lesson

One of God's greatest rewards is becoming more like Christ.

4. The Reward of Kingdom Impact

Faithful stewardship affects more than the individual believer.

It impacts families, churches, communities, and future generations.

Galatians 6:9

“And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.”

Examples of Kingdom impact include:

- Souls won to Christ
- Disciples developed
- Churches strengthened
- Families transformed
- Communities blessed

Many believers may never fully see the results of their faithfulness during their lifetime.

However, God uses faithful stewardship to accomplish purposes that extend far beyond what we can imagine.

Illustration

A seed planted today may produce fruit for many years.

Likewise, acts of faithful stewardship often create lasting spiritual influence.

Principle

Faithfulness today can impact generations tomorrow.

5. The Joy of God's Approval

The greatest reward is not material blessing but God's approval.

Matthew 25:21

“Well done, thou good and faithful servant.”

Every believer longs to hear these words from Christ.

Human praise is temporary, but God's approval is eternal.

Many people live seeking the approval of others, but faithful stewards seek first to please God.

Colossians 3:23

“And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men.”

Reflection

If no one ever recognized your service, would you still serve faithfully for God alone?

Faithful stewards answer yes because they know God sees everything.

6. Eternal Rewards in Heaven

The Bible teaches that believers will one day stand before Christ to give an account of their stewardship.

Revelation 22:12

“And, behold, I come quickly; and my reward is with me.”

This judgment is not about salvation but about rewards for faithful service.

2 Corinthians 5:10

“For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ.”

God will evaluate:

- Motives
- Faithfulness
- Service
- Obedience
- Stewardship

Important Truth

Salvation is received through faith, but rewards are granted according to faithfulness.

7. Rewards That Endure Forever

1 Corinthians 3:14

“If any man's work abide which he hath built thereupon, he shall receive a reward.”

Many earthly accomplishments eventually disappear.

- Wealth fades.
- Possessions wear out.
- Fame is forgotten.

However, spiritual investments produce eternal rewards.

Eternal Investments Include

- Winning souls
- Making disciples
- Teaching God's Word
- Supporting ministry
- Helping others
- Living faithfully

Matthew 6:20

“But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven.”

Principle

The wisest investment is one that lasts forever.

8. Avoiding the Loss of Reward

Although salvation is secure in Christ, believers can lose opportunities for reward through unfaithfulness.

1 Corinthians 3:15

“He himself shall be saved; yet so as by fire.”

Examples of unfaithfulness include:

- Neglecting responsibilities
- Wasting opportunities
- Misusing resources
- Serving with wrong motives
- Living in disobedience

2 John 1:8

“Look to yourselves, that we lose not those things which we have wrought.”

Lesson

Faithfulness today protects rewards tomorrow.

9. Living with an Eternal Perspective

Faithful stewards understand that life on earth is temporary.

Colossians 3:2

“Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth.”

An eternal perspective changes priorities.

Instead of living only for:

- Comfort
- Possessions
- Status
- Personal gain

Believers begin living for:

- God's glory
- Kingdom advancement
- Eternal rewards
- Faithful service

Key Truth

People who live for eternity make different decisions than those who live only for today.

Characteristics of a Reward-Worthy Steward

A faithful steward:

- Remains faithful in small things.
 - Serves without seeking recognition.
 - Uses resources wisely.
 - Perseveres through challenges.
 - Invests in God's Kingdom.
 - Seeks God's approval above human praise.
 - Maintains an eternal perspective.
 - Finishes the race faithfully.
-

Case Study

The Unseen Worker

For twenty years, Martha faithfully cleaned the church sanctuary every Saturday.

Few people noticed her work, and she was rarely publicly recognized.

Yet she continued serving joyfully because she believed she was serving Christ.

At the end of her life, she left behind a testimony of humility, faithfulness, and devotion.

Questions

1. Why did Martha continue serving even without recognition?
 2. What reward was she ultimately seeking?
 3. How does her example challenge believers today?
-

Practical Applications

1. Evaluate your faithfulness in daily responsibilities.
 2. Serve God even when no one notices.
 3. Continue developing and using your gifts.
 4. Invest more time and resources in Kingdom work.
 5. Focus on eternal values rather than temporary rewards.
 6. Persevere through difficulties without giving up.
 7. Live each day with eternity in mind.
-

Discussion Questions

1. Why does God reward faithfulness rather than worldly success?
 2. How does faithfulness in small things prepare believers for greater responsibilities?
 3. What are some examples of eternal rewards?
 4. Why is God's approval more important than human recognition?
 5. How can believers maintain an eternal perspective?
 6. In what areas of stewardship do you need to become more faithful?
-

Chapter Summary

God honours and rewards faithful stewardship. Whether managing time, talents, finances, relationships, opportunities, or ministry responsibilities, believers are called to serve faithfully and obediently.

Faithfulness leads to spiritual growth, greater responsibility, Kingdom impact, and eternal rewards. Above all, faithful stewards live for the day when they will hear Christ say:

“Well done, good and faithful servant.”

Their greatest desire is not earthly success but God's approval and the privilege of bringing glory to Him.

Key Lesson

God rewards faithfulness. Those who faithfully manage what He entrusts to them will experience spiritual growth,

Kingdom impact, greater responsibility, God's approval, and eternal rewards.

FINAL COURSE SUMMARY

STEWARDSHIP

Faithfully Managing What God Has Entrusted to Us

Introduction

Stewardship is one of the most important principles in the Christian life. It is the recognition that God is the Owner of all things and that believers are entrusted as managers of His resources.

Everything we possess—our time, talents, finances, opportunities, relationships, influence, spiritual gifts, and ministry responsibilities—has been entrusted to us by God for His purposes and glory.

Throughout this course, we have learned that stewardship is not limited to money. It encompasses every area of life. God calls His people to faithfully manage what He has given them and to use those resources in ways that honour Him, bless others, and advance His Kingdom.

A faithful steward understands that life is not about ownership but responsibility. The question is not:

"What do I own?"

but rather,

"How am I managing what God has entrusted to me?"

The Foundation of Stewardship

The foundation of biblical stewardship is God's ownership.

Psalm 24:1

"The earth is the LORD'S, and the fullness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein."

Everything belongs to God.

God owns:

- Our lives
- Our families
- Our abilities
- Our possessions
- Our finances
- Our opportunities
- Our ministries
- Our future

Since God owns everything, believers are called to manage His resources according to His will.

Stewardship begins when we surrender ownership and acknowledge God's authority over every area of our lives.

Course Theme

Faithful Stewardship Honours God

Faithful stewardship honours God through wise management of time, talents, finances, relationships, resources, and opportunities entrusted to His people.

When believers faithfully manage what God has entrusted to them, they become instruments of His blessing, advance His Kingdom, impact future generations, and prepare themselves for the day they will stand before Christ.

COURSE REVIEW

Throughout this course we have discovered that stewardship affects every area of life.

We learned that:

God Owns Everything

Believers are managers, not owners.

Time Must Be Used Wisely

Time cannot be recovered once lost.

Talents and Gifts Should Be Developed

God expects believers to discover, develop, and use their gifts faithfully.

Financial Resources Should Be Managed Responsibly

Money should be earned honestly, spent wisely, saved prudently, and given generously.

Relationships Are Sacred Trusts

Families, friendships, and church relationships should be nurtured with love, forgiveness, and integrity.

Opportunities Should Be Recognized and Seized

Open doors from God should be embraced before they pass.

Faithfulness Brings Rewards

God rewards faithful stewardship with spiritual growth, Kingdom impact, greater responsibility, and eternal rewards.

The Steward's Perspective

A faithful steward understands that:

- Every resource carries responsibility.
- Every blessing carries accountability.
- Every opportunity has a purpose.
- Every act of obedience matters.
- Every faithful service is noticed by God.

Faithful stewards do not live merely for earthly success.

They live for the day when they will hear Christ say:

"Well done, thou good and faithful servant."

(Matthew 25:21)

Final Key Lesson

God owns everything, and believers are accountable stewards entrusted with managing His resources faithfully for His glory and Kingdom purposes.

Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for entrusting us with time, talents, finances, relationships, opportunities, and spiritual gifts.

Help us to be faithful stewards who honour You in every area of life. Teach us to use wisely all that You have placed in our hands. Guard us from selfishness, laziness, fear, and neglect.

May our lives bring glory to Your name, bless others, and advance Your Kingdom. Strengthen us to remain faithful until the day we hear Your words:

"Well done, good and faithful servant."

In Jesus' name we pray.

Amen.

SECTION A: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

(20 Marks)

Choose the correct answer.

1. What is biblical stewardship?

A. Owning everything you possess

B. Managing God's resources faithfully

- C. Giving money to the church
 - D. Working hard
-

2. According to Psalm 24:1, who owns everything?

- A. Governments
 - B. Individuals
 - C. God
 - D. Churches
-

3. What is the primary requirement of a steward?

- A. Wealth
 - B. Education
 - C. Faithfulness
 - D. Popularity
-

4. Which scripture teaches that stewards must be found faithful?

- A. Matthew 6:33
- B. Romans 12:1
- C. 1 Corinthians 4:2

D. John 3:16

5. Which of the following is NOT an area of stewardship?

- A. Time
 - B. Talents
 - C. Weather
 - D. Finances
-

6. According to Ephesians 5:15–16, believers should:

- A. Ignore time
 - B. Redeem the time
 - C. Waste opportunities
 - D. Depend on others
-

7. According to Psalm 90:12, numbering our days gives us:

- A. Riches
 - B. Fame
 - C. Wisdom
 - D. Authority
-

8. Who gives spiritual gifts?

- A. Parents
 - B. Church leaders
 - C. God
 - D. Society
-

9. According to 1 Peter 4:10, gifts should be used to:

- A. Gain popularity
 - B. Serve others
 - C. Gain wealth
 - D. Impress people
-

10. Which chapter teaches stewardship of financial resources?

- A. Chapter 2
 - B. Chapter 3
 - C. Chapter 4
 - D. Chapter 5
-

11. According to Malachi 3:10, believers should:

- A. Ignore giving
 - B. Bring the whole tithe
 - C. Borrow money
 - D. Save everything
-

12. What does Proverbs 3:9 teach?

- A. Honour the Lord with your wealth
 - B. Avoid working
 - C. Save all money
 - D. Seek wealth only
-

13. According to 2 Corinthians 9:7, God loves a:

- A. Wealthy giver
 - B. Reluctant giver
 - C. Cheerful giver
 - D. Famous giver
-

14. Stewardship of relationships teaches believers to:

- A. Value possessions more than people
- B. Avoid church members

C. Treat people with love and integrity

D. Isolate themselves

15. According to Galatians 6:10, believers should:

A. Do good to all people

B. Serve only themselves

C. Ignore others

D. Compete with others

16. What did Jesus say about working while it is day?

A. Rest completely

B. Work only when convenient

C. Do the works of God

D. Wait until tomorrow

17. Faithfulness in little things leads to:

A. Laziness

B. Failure

C. Greater responsibility

D. Pride

18. What reward did the faithful servant receive in Matthew 25:21?

- A. Wealth only
 - B. A new house
 - C. The master's approval
 - D. Popularity
-

19. According to Revelation 22:12, Jesus will:

- A. Ignore stewardship
 - B. Bring rewards
 - C. Remove responsibilities
 - D. End opportunities
-

20. What is the overall theme of this course?

- A. Wealth creation
 - B. Church growth
 - C. Faithful stewardship
 - D. Leadership development
-

SECTION B: TRUE OR FALSE

(5 Marks)

Write **True** or **False**.

21.

Stewardship only involves money.

22.

God owns everything.

23.

Time can be recovered once it is lost.

24.

Every believer has gifts from God.

25.

Faithfulness is important in stewardship.

SECTION C: SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

(15 Marks)

26.

Define biblical stewardship.

27.

Name **four areas of stewardship** discussed in this course.

a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

28.

Why should believers use their gifts?

29.

Why is accountability important in stewardship?

30.

What words does every faithful steward desire to hear from the Lord?

END OF EXAMINATION

"Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful."

— 1 Corinthians 4:2 (KJV)

STEWARD'S COMMITMENT

I acknowledge that God is the Owner of all things and that I am His steward.

By God's grace, I commit myself to faithfully manage my **time, talents, finances, relationships, opportunities, spiritual gifts, and ministry responsibilities** for His glory and the advancement of His Kingdom.

I desire to live in such a way that I may one day hear my Lord say:

"Well done, good and faithful servant."

Student Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

END OF COURSE

STEWARDSHIP

Faithfully Managing What God Has Entrusted to Us

GracePath Network

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"Freely ye have received, freely give."

— **Matthew 10:8 (KJV)**

STEWARDSHIP

Faithfully Managing What God Has Entrusted to Us

Everything we have belongs to God. He is the Owner; we are His stewards. This course is a practical and Bible-based guide to help believers understand and apply the principles of stewardship in every area of life.

Good stewardship is not about having more, but about managing well what God has entrusted to us for His glory and the blessing of others. When we are faithful with what is in our hands, God can trust us with more and through us accomplish His eternal purposes.

INSIDE THIS COURSE YOU WILL LEARN:

-  How to redeem your time and live purposefully
-  How to discover, develop and use your talents and gifts
-  How to manage financial resources with wisdom and generosity
-  How to build and maintain healthy relationships
-  How to recognize and seize God-given opportunities
-  The eternal rewards of faithful stewardship



“
*Moreover it is
required in stewards,
that a man be
found faithful.*”

”
1 CORINTHIANS 4:2 (KJV)

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

DAVID NGURE – GRACEPATH NETWORK

David Ngure is a servant of God, teacher, and mentor with a passion for discipleship and Kingdom impact. Through GracePath Network, he equips believers with Biblical truth, practical tools, and inspiring resources to grow in Christ and fulfill their God-given purpose.



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Be faithful in little and you will be entrusted with much.

MATTHEW 25:21